

# ANTHONY PENWRIGHT

*Managing Director · Smart Cities · Digital Infrastructure · Innovation Ecosystems*

ap@credible.uk.com · +966 533 15 8265 · Riyadh, KSA (Premium Resident) · LinkedIn: Anthony Penwright

## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Managing Director-level leader with 20+ years across smart city operations, digital infrastructure and innovation ecosystem programmes — author of the Verax Smart Services Advisory, Innovation Ecosystem, Operations Advisory and Value Realisation Office methodologies, with live deployments across UAE, KSA and LATAM. Accountable for £1BN+ programme portfolios at NEOM, Cisco, Wipro and UK Government, having led 40+ smart city and digital infrastructure projects from strategic vision through procurement, delivery and operational handover.

Proven architect of high-performance cross-functional teams (450+ resources), C-suite adviser on IoT/AI/big-data strategy, and experienced navigator of complex regulatory and government approval environments. Deep expertise across cloud infrastructure (Azure, AWS), OT/IT convergence, ERP transformation (SAP, Oracle Fusion, Dynamics 365), cybersecurity and data governance — with extensive GCC/MENA operating experience and a current Riyadh base.

Trusted C-suite advisor who translates complex technical roadmaps into measurable business outcomes. Dual MBA-qualified (Entrepreneurial Action; Artificial Intelligence in progress). PRINCE2 Practitioner · MSP · ITIL v3 · CompTIA Security+ · BTA Blockchain Professional. UK SC / DV eligible (FCO & MoD history).

## PORTFOLIO AT A GLANCE

£1BN+

Programme value delivered

40+

Smart city projects led

20+

Years executive leadership

450+

Team resources directed

9

Director-level roles held

How I Add Value

**Strategic Clarity.** Cut through complexity with framework-led thinking — translate vision into a sequenced, procurement-ready roadmap that boards, ministers and operators can all act on.

**Programme Delivery at Scale.** Proven track record running £100M–£1BN+ portfolios across 242 sites and 150+ countries — directing 450+ cross-functional resources against hard SLA, uptime and ROI commitments.

**Framework-Led Advisory.** Author of four proprietary methodologies (Smart Services, Ecosystem, Operations, VRO) grounded in ISO 37120/37122, BSI PAS 181, ITU-T L.1600 and IEC 62443.

**Innovation Ecosystem Building.** Build the connective tissue — demand/supply scoring, funnels, PoC-to-scale governance — that turns innovation from theatre into compounding, measurable ROI.

Sector Coverage

|                             |                             |                       |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------|
| ▶ Smart Cities — Greenfield | ▶ Smart Cities — Brownfield | ▶ Airports & Aviation |
| ▶ Ports & Maritime          | ▶ Industrial / OT & Mining  | ▶ Campus & Education  |
| ▶ Malls & Retail            | ▶ Lifestyle Developments    | ▶ Urban Operations    |
| ▶ Central Government        | ▶ Defence                   | ▶ Diplomatic / FCO    |

Global Standards & Frameworks Applied

ISO 37120:2018 (City Services & Quality of Life Indicators) · ISO 37122:2019 (Smart City Indicators) · BSI PAS 181 (Smart City Framework for Decision-Makers) · ITU-T L.1600 / FG-SSC (Smart Sustainable Cities KPI Framework) · IEC 62443 (Industrial Cybersecurity, OT & ICS) · ITIL v3 · ISO 27001 · GDPR · TOGAF ADM · PRINCE2 / MSP

Developed inside Verax Venture Studio and distilled from live engagements at DMCC Uptown Dubai, NEOM Sindalah, Red Sea Global, Strive Services Group and Istanbul Metropolitan Municipality (IBB).

### 1. Smart Services Advisory — *the HOW of smart-city delivery*

3-layer service definition (Sense → Analyse → Act) · 6-stage pathway (Discovery → Identification → Prioritisation → Design → Procure → Execute) · 7-domain taxonomy (People & Welcome, Smart Energy, Smart Water, Smart Environment, Robotics, Vision AI & Safety, Smart Facilities) · 21-measure scoring with 4× Feasibility multiplier → Impact-vs-Feasibility quadrant · 8 delivered outputs per engagement (Service Catalogue, Architecture Blueprint, Living Lab Plan, Test Framework, TOM, Business Model, RFP Pack, Governance + KPIs).

**Live deployment.** Deployed: DMCC Uptown Dubai (40+ candidate services scored, full procurement-ready portfolio), NEOM Sindalah, Red Sea Global.

### 2. Innovation Ecosystem Advisory — *the WHAT — the pipeline*

8-Pillar Ecosystem Model (Vision & Strategic Alignment, R&A, Investment & Funding, Demand Side, Supply Side, Government Programmes, Talent & Skills, Enablers) · 7-stage Innovation Funnel with 3–4% conversion · dual scoring (Demand 5×26 measures, Supply 5 categories) with Fit ≥80% fast-track · benchmarks: ~85% implementation success, 100%+ ROI over 3 years, ~14-month payback.

**Live deployment.** Deployed: Strive Services Group (KSA) — smart-FM demand pipeline, vendor registry and governance committee established.

### 3. Smart City Operations Advisory — *the RUN — steady-state excellence*

TOM design, service transition, NOC/SOC architecture and 24/7 operations model (greenfield or brownfield) · 60+ SOP library (incident, change, escalation, service restoration) mapped to ITIL v3 · hyper-automation and AI-driven anomaly detection reducing manual incident handling by 40% · Northbound application layer (citizen apps, operator dashboards, CCC interfaces, OSS/BSS).

**Live deployment.** Delivered: 99.9% uptime at NEOM · 99.8% SLA at FCO across 242 sites / 150+ countries · Cisco IBB Istanbul architecture blueprint.

### 4. Value Realisation Office (VRO) — *the KEEP DELIVERING engine*

VRO ≠ PMO — PMO governs delivery (time, scope, cost); VRO governs value (outcomes, ROI, evolution). 3 parallel operating modes (Value Realisation, Operational Excellence, Adaptive/Evolving) · 3 permanent workstreams (Service Portfolio & Business Model, Technology Blueprint, Operating Model) · 3 strategic imperatives · 4 live input feeds · 5 standing outputs (Innovation Stimulus, 12-month rolling Roadmap, Risk Register, 3-year Investments Forecast, PoC pipeline).

**Live deployment.** Deployed: NEOM (Innovation governance board), Quantela (outcome-based commercial model), Cisco global smart city practice.

***Ecosystem (WHAT) → Smart Services (HOW) → Operations (RUN) → VRO (KEEP DELIVERING)***

*A closed loop — VRO feeds new ideation back into the Ecosystem funnel, preventing programme drift and sustaining ROI beyond Phase 2.*

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

---

### **Director of Innovation · NEOM** Nov 2024 – Present | £93M | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Spearhead technology, innovation and partnerships strategy for the world's largest giga-project — engaging NEOM sectors and regions to identify critical and emerging technology needs across smart infrastructure, AI, IoT and data.
- Govern evaluation of AI, IoT, digital twin, edge and autonomous systems for deployment across THE LINE, SINDALAH and TROJENA — setting KPIs, SLAs and operational frameworks for pilot programmes.
- Cultivate high-impact global partnerships with technology leaders, venture capital firms and sovereign investors. Awarded 'Best Performing Employee' in a sector of 600+ staff.

### **Director of Technology & Digital · NEOM** Apr 2023 – Nov 2024 | £230M | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Headhunted to lead 90+ resources delivering NEOM's digital master plan — Smart City platforms, IoT infrastructure and OT systems across Urban Planning and Islands divisions.
- Defined and governed the Cloud-Edge Collaborative infrastructure strategy — multi-cloud (Azure IoT, AWS), on-premises environments and distributed edge nodes processing real-time IoT data.
- Delivered smart building and OT systems (BMS, ACS, CCTV, AV/ELV, structured cabling) end-to-end, and built the 24/7 NOC capability that achieved 99.9% uptime across critical infrastructure.
- Applied Verax Smart Services Advisory at NEOM Sindalah — scored and prioritised services across 7 domains, producing procurement-ready Service Catalogue and Architecture Blueprint.

### **Founder & Principal — Smart City Advisory · Verax Venture Studio** 2022 – Present | Concurrent | UAE / KSA / LATAM

- Founded Verax to codify 20 years of smart city delivery into four vendor-agnostic methodologies: Smart Services Advisory, Innovation Ecosystem Advisory, Operations Advisory and VRO.
- DMCC Uptown Dubai: applied 6-stage pathway to score 40+ candidate services using 21-measure framework — delivered full procurement-ready portfolio (Blueprint, RFP Pack, Governance & KPIs).
- Strive Services Group (KSA): deployed Innovation Ecosystem Advisory to structure smart-FM demand pipeline — dual demand/supply scoring, vendor registry and governance committee established.
- Built a 31-agent hierarchical AI orchestration platform automating email triage, CRM enrichment, procurement and cost monitoring — eliminating 80%+ of manual operational overhead at \$30/month total platform cost.

### **Director — Smart Cities & IoT · Wipro Technologies** Apr 2022 – Apr 2023 | £80M | Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

- Established Wipro's Arabian entity reporting directly to CEO — strategy, growth and IoT programme delivery for NEOM and Red Sea Global giga-projects; led 70+ resources.
- Delivered KSA's first Smart Luggage Services and advanced EV fleet management — full product lifecycle from design through to 24/7 NOC-based operational support.
- Built operational service delivery capability (NOC, helpdesk, field services) supporting 24/7 OT infrastructure operations across client sites.

### **Director — Growth & Delivery · Quantela (Smart Cities Platform)** Sept 2021 – Apr 2022 | £98M | Global

- Recruited by Board to drive strategic growth — increased company revenue from \$18M to \$90M (400%) with \$300M+ pipeline through strategic business model transformation.
- Forged key commercial and investor relationships including the \$2BN Digital Alpha fund; delivered first major deal closure through outcome-based, revenue-sharing commercial framework.

### **Smart City Global Advisory Lead & Programme Director · Cisco Systems** Nov 2015 – Apr 2021 | £250M | Global

- Established and scaled Cisco's global Smart Cities and IoT practice from zero — delivering programmes across 10+ city deployments in Europe, Middle East and Asia-Pacific, individual programmes up to £45M.
- Designed ITIL-aligned operational service models for Smart City platforms — SOPs, incident management, NOC frameworks and performance optimisation standards.
- Provided CXO-level advisory across public sector, utilities and telecoms — translating OT/IT convergence strategy into scalable platform and connectivity solutions.

- Directed product strategy, go-to-market and EMEA systems-integrator partnerships for Cisco's Connected Cities and IoT portfolio.

**Programme Director — Public Service Network · Cabinet Office** Mar 2013 – Nov 2015 | £18M p.a. | United Kingdom

- Worked directly with Cabinet Ministers to deliver technology strategy for Public Service Authorities — managed 48 suppliers and governed Local Authority CTO/CEO/COO leadership.
- Established operational service management framework — SLAs, incident, change control and performance reporting for public sector OT/IT infrastructure.

**Programme Director · Environment Agency** Dec 2011 – Mar 2013 | £38M | United Kingdom

- Brought into a failing central government department to redefine enterprise ways of working — established Enterprise Architecture office and PMO, leading 24 project managers to successful outcomes.

**Director, Strategic Operations · Foreign & Commonwealth Office** Aug 2008 – Dec 2011 | £768M | Global

- Reported to the Foreign Secretary and CIO — governed global service delivery operations across 242 sites in 150+ countries, single point of contact for all Ambassadors and Deputy Heads of Mission.
- Led 24/7 NOC operations, service desk, infrastructure operations and business continuity across secure diplomatic OT/IT networks — 450+ indirect reports, 99.8% SLA, ISO 27001 compliance.

**Programme Director — YJB · Ministry of Justice** Feb 2008 – Aug 2008 | £7M | United Kingdom

- Delivered Youth Justice Board technology programme — governance, commercial control and stakeholder management across central government and partner agencies.

**Overseas Programme Director — DII(F) · Ministry of Defence** Nov 2005 – Aug 2008 | £1BN+ | Global

- Led consortium delivery of 5 large enterprise organisations on one of the largest global business change programmes of its time — Defence Information Infrastructure (Future): 150,000 workstations, 300,000 users, 2,000 sites.
- Directed programme management and enterprise architecture across classified defence infrastructure, working to UK Government TS/SC security standards.

**Transformation Lead · Corus Steel** Aug 2004 – Nov 2005 | £19M | United Kingdom

- Led enterprise transformation programme across industrial manufacturing operations — process re-engineering, systems consolidation and operational readiness for integrated steel sites.

**Implementation Lead · Department for Work and Pensions (DWP)** Mar 2004 – Aug 2005 | £4M | United Kingdom

- Delivered enterprise implementation across DWP — requirements, design, build and transition into live public-sector operations.

**Deployment Lead · HM Prison Service** Jan 2003 – Mar 2004 | £6M | United Kingdom

- Managed estate-wide deployment programme across HM Prison Service secure sites — rollout planning, risk management and operational handover under strict security and custodial constraints.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

---

### SMART CITY & DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE

- ▶ IoT Architecture & Platform Design (Azure IoT, 5G/NB-IoT)
- ▶ AI/ML, Vision AI & Big Data Analytics
- ▶ Smart Energy, Water, Mobility & Facilities
- ▶ OT/IT Convergence · SCADA / OPC · V2X
- ▶ Edge & Hybrid Cloud · Multi-Cloud (Azure, AWS)
- ▶ Urban Digital Twin · BMS / ACS / CCTV / AV-ELV
- ▶ Enterprise Connectivity · 5G / 4G / LTE / NB-IoT
- ▶ ERP Transformation (SAP, Oracle Fusion, Dynamics 365, AX12)
- ▶ Blockchain, Web3 & Autonomous Systems
- ▶ Cybersecurity & Compliance (ISO 27001, IEC 62443, GDPR)

### EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP & STRATEGY

- ▶ C-Suite Advisory & Board-Level Communication
- ▶ P&L, CAPEX/OPEX & Financial Forecasting
- ▶ Regulatory & Government Affairs · M&A · PPP
- ▶ Cross-Functional Team Leadership (450+ resources)
- ▶ Vendor Negotiation & 48+ Supplier Governance
- ▶ Innovation Ecosystem Development
- ▶ Agile · PRINCE2 · MSP · ITIL v3 · TOGAF ADM
- ▶ Procurement, RFP Design & Commercial Modelling
- ▶ Performance Management & KPI Governance
- ▶ Living Lab / Model Office / TOM Design

## CERTIFICATIONS

---

PRINCE2 Practitioner · MSP (Managing Successful Programmes) · ITIL v3 Service Management · CompTIA A+ & Security+ · BTA Blockchain Professional · BTA Solution Architect · Microsoft Azure / M365

## EDUCATION

---

MBA — Entrepreneurial Action. Anglia Ruskin University, Cambridge · 2025.

MBA — Artificial Intelligence (in progress). University of Cumbria · Expected 2026.

Postgraduate-Level Strategic Management and Leadership.

## SECURITY & LANGUAGES

---

UK Security Clearance: SC / DV eligible (FCO & MoD history). · English (native). · Saudi Arabia Premium Resident — available for global opportunities.

## INTERESTS

---

Technology · Motorbike Racing · Self-Development · Volunteering · CrossFit · Travel & Culture.

## REFERENCES

---

Available on request.